Human Sciences - ToK

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Mr. Evans and the “loaded question” ..

- “Any true HoF should be able to ….”
- A loaded question – a problem with the human sciences
- Understanding logical fallacies are the quickest way to understanding how not to be manipulated

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- Phillip Evans

None of this information is MINE ! Websites I collated information from

- HTTP://IBDIPLOMA.CAMBRIDGE.ORG/MEDIA/IB_TOK_9_RESOURCES_CS9.PDF
- ps://www.wcpss.net/Page/7359
- https://www.theoryofknowledge.net/areas-of-knowledge/the-human-sciences/what-are-the-aims-of-the-human-sciences/
- https://libguides.tts.edu.sg/tok/humanscience
- HTTPS://LIBGUIDES.TTS.EDU.SG/TOK/HUMANSCIENCE
- http://sohowdoweknow.weebly.com/human-sciences.html

Human Sciences … Or the art of being a Jedi …!

- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GO_xfR64qSk

- Source : youtube

Do Governments Seek to Change behavior ?

- China's "Social Credit" system

Human Sciences A definition

- "A branch of study which deals with people or their actions, including the social sciences and the humanities, as contrasted with the natural sciences or physical sciences" (Oxford).

Human Sciences : Why ?

- What causes us to behave in the way we do, and what causes human phenomena to occur?

Insights and Applications from Human Sciences

- Insights on how people react to things
- Insight to explain human behaviour
- Helps us understand how to manipulate Human beings.

- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HgofBPShoaU
- Source : youtube
- Insights to Predict Behaviour

How Important is this ? Who will find it Useful ? For Good or Bad ?

1. Government for peace time and war
2. Business Organizations
   - Human resources
   - Economics and impact on Online dating
   - industry
   - Increase in profits from understanding human behaviour
3. Personal
   - Self help (Anthony Robbins Neural networks)
   - relationships (dating and family)
4. Entertainment
   - Magicians

Human Sciences Vs natural Sciences

- The human sciences might be classified as science because they use the scientific method to test the validity and reliability of hypotheses.
- However, unlike the natural sciences, the phenomena they try to explain might not possess hard and fast laws that admit no exceptions.
- They might therefore resort to statistical methods to establish their findings, producing knowledge that is less reliable in terms of issuing predictions.

Source : https://www.wcpss.net/Page/7359

Problems with Human Sciences

1. Mistaking Causation and Correlation
2. Mistaking Cause and Effect : Chicken or the Egg ?
3. Apophenia
4. Ethics
5. Personal Motivations and Social customs
6. Observer Effect

1 Causation and Correlation

- **Causation** indicates a relationship between two events where one event is affected by the other.
- **Correlations** indicates that the two events are connected to each other !

Causation and Correlation & Cause and Effect can often be Confused

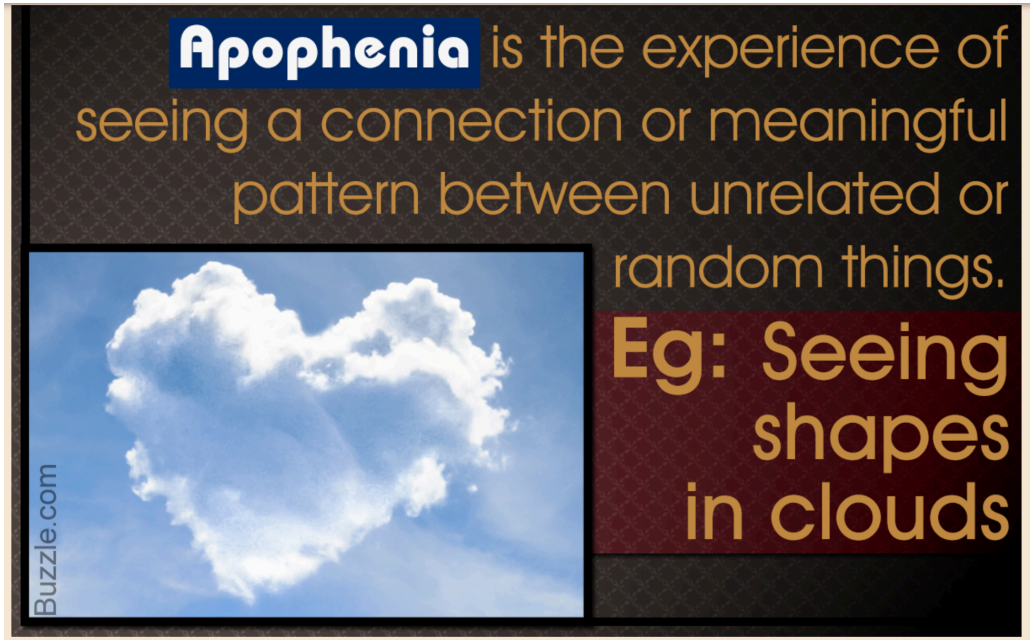
- How can we be sure that one event is CAUSED by another ?

- Once Upon time Americans once thought ice cream causes POLIO ! As POLIO and ice cream sales would spike in Summer.
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8B271L3NtAw

- Source : Youtube

3 Apophenia

- Seeing recognizable objects or **patterns** in otherwise random or unrelated objects or **patterns** is **called** pareidolia. It's a form of apophenia, which is a more general term for the human tendency to seek **patterns** in random information.



Is it Ethically Right to use abortions as a tool to reduce crime ? How can we prove causation ?

- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=zk6gOeggViw

- Abortion caused the crime rates in America to fall.

Personal Motivations and Social customs

- AJ Ayer (philosopher “Logical Positivism”)

Why Does an animal go to the river bank ?

- The animal is thirsty !

Why Does a man hold up a glass of wine ?

Seduction



Personal Motivations and Social customs

- Personal motivations and differences in social customs will skew theories about human behaviour.

6. Observer Effect

- When being observed, the subjects may awkward and may behave in a different way than if alone.

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How do we know ?

- Direct Observations and experimentation !
- Use of models
- Use of questionaires
- Use of reason to construct possible theory and deduce effects
- Use of assumptions

- Each one of the the above has flaws which could invalidate the “truth”.

Ways Of Knowing

- Language - YES
- Sense perception - YES
- Emotion - YES
- Reason - YES
- Imagination
- Faith
- Intuition - YES

Ways Of Knowing

- **Sense perception :**
  Sense perception has three steps:
  We **perceive** the world through our five **senses**. (Hearing, Sight, Smell, Touch, Taste) Our **sense** receptors are stimulated by **sensory** information
- In order to fully perceive we need other ways of knowing such as Language

Ways Of Knowing

- Language – Topic Specific Words
  e.g. long term and short term

- There are specific CONCEPTS and ASSUMPTIONS are that used across topics as a basis of knowing and building knowledge.

Ways Of Knowing

- Reason – Using facts, figures and observations

  Use of Positive statements

Ways Of Knowing

- Intuition − Use of other similar studies observed and making links to outcomes of other case studies.

Ways Of Knowing

- Emotion − Normative statements
  “I feel that …..”

Historical Developments

- Have there been changes over time as a result of changing observations and belief systems ?

- E.g the emergence of
  "Nudge Economics"
  (those that enjoy Psychology and Economics)
  Assumptions of :-
  (1) Limited rationality - historical change
  (2) Non selfish social preference - historical change
  (3) Lack of self control

Links to personal Knowledge

- Most theories are easily transferable with links to personal experience.

- Chameleon effect − Psychology
  Singapore Queues
- Maslow's theory of motivation- Business Management/ HR/ Life
- Sunk costs − Economics and dating

Anthropology – By Emily Austin

Purpose of anthropology

Anthropologists study the cultures of living people



Methods used in anthro

Ethnography = systematic study of people and cultures.

- Use **ethnographic** methods designed to facilitate the researchers' understanding of people in other cultures
- Usually involves **participant observation** = where an anthropologist lives within a nature, as one of the natives, until they are competent or proficient in being one of them (at least one year is necessary) − common method of data collection for anthropologists

Historical development of anthropology

Early ideas of human anthropology as a study in human progress have been replaced with less value-laden (Western-centered) perspectives

19th & early-mid 20th century

= aim of anthropology was to map a trajectory of man in which white, civilised peoples were considered the most recent advancement on an evolutionary scale

= 'natives' considered to be a living museum of 'coloured' and 'primitive' people



→ While this kind of anthropology was clearly underpinned by racist ideology, this school of study reflected the widely held beliefs of the world at the time (Eugenics; Master Race Theory ect.)

→ Shift in anthropology methods/assumptions following the study of **Malinowsky in the early 20th century (now known as the 'grandfather' of modern anthropology)**

Historical development of anthropology: Bronisław Malinowski

- Polish anthropologist
- Set the stage for modern anthropology



Malinowski's study:

- Early 20th century − traveled from London to Papua New Guinea to study native patterns of exchange
- WWI (1914 − 1918) broke out → Malinowski unable to return home and so spent considerable time living and studying the Trobriand Islanders

Malinowski

Cultural relativism: the idea that a person's beliefs, values, and practices should be understood based on that person's own **culture**, rather than be judged against the criteria of another.

- First anthropologist to acknowledge thei
  production of scientific knowledge; he w
  interpreted the data and so he included his voice in his ethnographic writing
- Personal diaries reveal he struggled between the notions of 'us and them', between the old regime of a racism legitimating colonialism and a new regime which questioned the superiority that any one culture has over another = "cultural relativism" (significant shift from the previous assumptions underpinning anthropology)

→ ***His work paved the way for future anthropologists to look at culture differences without making arrogant, ethnocentric judgments***

Problems with participant observation in anthropology

- Social scientists have questioned the degree to which participant observation can give meaningful and accurate insight into the minds of other people
- Data will be restricted by the fact that the sole presence of the researcher in the field will likely influence the participants' behaviour

Reflections of a contemporary anthropologist

"I have studied many different peoples and their culture. I have lived in Spain for 15 months to learn about the lives of bullfighters. In Australia, I went to every fixture of the South Australian football team to learn the role of alcohol in fan culture…I have interviewed animals owners about the risks they take to save their pets from bushfires.

In every instance, I have been the student of someone else's way of life. I can now understand and explain why bullfighters don't see bullfighting as cruel and why killing the bull in the bullring is, in fact, an expression of love. I can explain why some football fans drink to dangerous excess…..and why some owners will run into burning homes to save their cat…

I may or may not agree with those behaviours and beliefs, but I can explain the internal cultural logic that makes them important…If you listen without judging, you may learn about other ways to see the world. If you can handle knowing that your view might not be the only one − or even the right one − you may even seen your own cultural beliefs and behaviours more critically than ever before.."

Ethical problems in anthropology

- What ethical thinking constrains the methods used to gain knowledge? (e.g. ethical constraints on experiments conducted in the human sciences)
  - Power-imbalance between the researcher and groups being studied
  - Implications for those being ‘studied’ – would you like a stranger observing and reporting your every move?; comparisons to animals in a zoo
  - Can minors give meaningful consent to being studied?
  - Dangers posed to the studied groups (exposed to diseases that they have not developed an immunity to)
  - Culturally insensitive research methods
  - Will research findings/data be used to reinforce negative stereotypes of studied groups?
  - What to do if the researcher is studying a population where illegal activities may occur?

KNOWLEDGE QUESTIONS

- Human sciences are less able to predict because humans have free will. But human sciences nevertheless try to establish laws of human behaviour. How can this be?
- To what extent are the methods of the human sciences ‘scientific’?
- How can one eliminate the effect of the observer being part of the system in the human sciences? (e.g. Hawthorne effect in psychology; field worker being part of the community in anthropology)
- How can we rely on the results from questionnaires given the problems of wording, leading questions, sampling and selection effects and the fact that respondents might not either know the truth about their own intentions or indeed tell it?

Business Management – By Jamuna Madhav

Scope and Application

- think critically and strategically about individual and organizational behaviour
- exploring business issues from different cultural perspectives
- importance of environmental, social and ethical factors in the actions of individuals and organizations

Concepts and Language

- concepts of change, culture, ethics, globalization, innovation and strategy

Methodology

- archival evidence
- data collection
- experimentation
- observation
- inductive and deductive reasoning

Historical development

- Early views of how we organise, coordinate and direct human activity towards collective goals.
- Historical observations on the tendency for male dominance hierarchies to shape organisational design and how alternative paradigms are emerging to adjust to the new realities of advanced economies.
- The first modern school of thought concerning management based on Frederick Taylor's principles of scientific management.
- Kurt Lewin's research on organizational development and group dynamics.
- Rise of the modern management gurus like Daniel Pink's whose theories builds upon older motivational theories but moves away from the notion that a system of rewards and punishments through extrinsic factors can motivate people.

Links to Personal Knowledge

- To what extent are the language and customs of business management based on the English language and Western tradition, and what implications does this have for business cultures around the world?
- Can individual motivation only emerge internally or can it be created externally? Is there such a thing as collective motivation?
- Do financial statements reflect the “truth” about a business?
- Is it possible to measure brand loyalty?
- To what extent is consumer behaviour rational?
- Is a quality product always more expensive to manufacture or buy than a mediocre product?
- Can one make an argument that the more people’s needs and wants are met, the more difficult innovation is?
- Can a business plan for a crisis?

Points of interest

1. Is free will an illusion ?
   https://psmag.com/social-justice/free-will-illusion-83861
2. Nature Vs. Nurture
   & the Milgram Experiment
   -Are humans Good Or Evil ?
   (Seen the movie ?)
   https://www.theoryofknowledge.net/areas-of-knowledge/the-human-sciences/classic-human-science-issues/
3. Stockholm Effect - Are kidnappers friends ?

Points of Interest

- Check the videos and articles on this page !

- http://sohowdoweknow.weebly.com/human-sciences.html